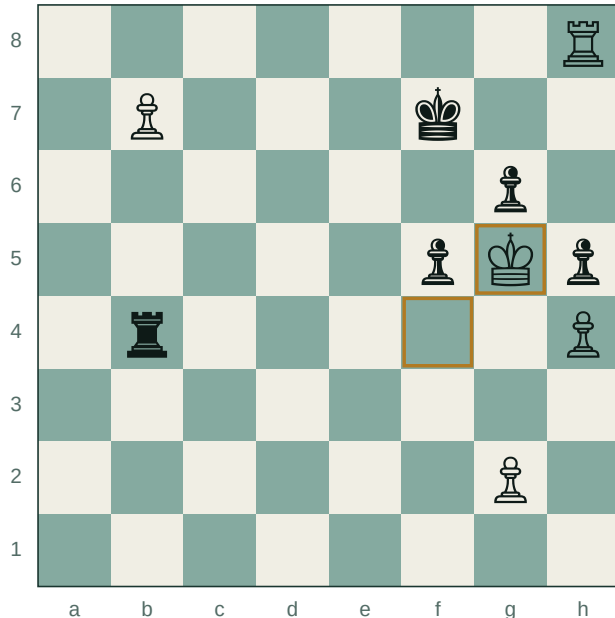


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 52

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 52.Kg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52...Kg7 53. Rg8+ Kxg8 54. b8=R+ Rxb8

52...Kg7 The king moves from f7 to g7. Recorded reply: **53.Rg8+**.

53...Kxg8 The king captures the rook on g8. Recorded reply: **54.b8=R+**.

54...Rxb8 The rook captures the rook on b8.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from +0 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.